

Westman Naturalists Inc. Annual General Meeting
Saturday, May 2, 2026, Riverbank Discovery Centre Meeting Room

Agenda

1. Call to order

- Welcome and introduction of board of directors
- Overview of meeting and procedures

2. Review and approval meeting agenda

3. Approval of past AGM minutes

4. President's report

- Summary and highlights of past activities
- Goals and upcoming initiatives

5. Committee reports

- Talks/presentations
- Outings
- Communications
- Organization
- Treasurer's report
- Projected 2026 budget

6. Other business

7. Election of directors

- Members at large

8. Adjournment

9. Nature walk

1. Call to order. The AGM was called to Order by the Chair, Dr. Alex Koiter, at **1312**. The WN bylaws require 10% of paid members for quorum. Quorum was achieved with 29 of 50 members present. Members in attendance are recorded at the end of the minutes.

Welcome and introduction of board of directors. The President welcomed everyone to the Westman Naturalists Inc. (WN) first Annual General Meeting and provided some opening remarks.

- The WN exist for important reasons: to offer educational opportunities and share knowledge about nature through presentations and field trips; to encourage the study and protection of the natural world around us; to help collect and provide data on species and the environment; and to support both science and education. We are here to act as stewards of the environment, doing our part to care for places we explore.
- This meeting marks something new for our group. In 2019, a few of us started talking about a naturalist group and I am very proud of how far we have come. It is through the dedication

of our volunteer board and committee members and everyone who has come to an outing or a talk.

- The Board members are as follows: Alex Koiter, serving as President, Speakers committee; Jen Wasko as Vice-President, Organization and planning committee; Kathryn Hyndman, Secretary, Organization and planning committee; Sandy Hominick, Treasurer, Organization and planning committee; Carson Kearns, Member at large, Communications and Outings committees; Gillian Richards, Member at large, Outings, Communications, and Organization and planning committees; Steffi LaZerte, Member at large, Speakers committee and managing our web presence.
- The President acknowledged Dr. Glennis Lewis, who served as Member at large and member of the Organization and planning committee. Glennis passed away recently, and this was a big loss for the WN and the entire Westman region because she was a strong advocate for conservation and environmental protection. Please join me in thanking Glennis and all the current Board members for volunteering their time and making this an awesome organization!
- The President thanked the Organization and planning committee members, Jen, Kathryn, Gillian and Sandy, for the huge amount of work they did to create our bylaws, set up our financial account, and for the work leading to the WN incorporation as a non-profit organization.

Overview of meeting and procedures. Alex, as President, will serve as meeting Chair and reminded members that those who have paid their annual membership fee are eligible to vote on items that may arise. Please raise your hand if you have any questions or concerns during the meeting. The meeting will begin with a report from each committee followed by the election of Members at large. Once the meeting wraps up there are snacks and drinks followed by a nature walk around the Riverbank Centre.

2.0 Review and approval meeting agenda.

The agenda was posted online and there are copies at your table. There were no additions or deletions to the agenda.

Motion: To approve the 2026 WN agenda as posted online.

Mover: D. Ford

Second: C. Pierce

Carried: All in favour

3. Approval of past AGM minutes.

Since this is our first AGM, there are no previous minutes.

4. President's report

Summary and highlights of past activities. One of the biggest highlights was the official incorporation of WN as a Manitoba non-profit organization, March 3, 2025. Our group stayed busy over the entire year with a variety of talks and outings.

Talks and presentations. In November 2025, Sean guided us through a talk on carnivorous plants of the north, which are as wild as they sound! Denice gave us a Valentine treat in February 2026 with “Bugs Do It Better”, a dive into insect adaptations. In March we had “Birding for Beginners”, a panel presentation that drew many new folks out with their binoculars. Emily, a Brandon University science student, shared her research on mosses at Waggle Springs. David gave us a “Park for all Seasons” look at the Manitoba provincial park system with a focus on the Western region. And Megan gave us an awesome Hallowe’en themed talk on “Spooky Creatures of the Prairies”, shining a light on some misunderstood prairie creatures. Alex thanked all the speakers for volunteering their time and expertise and recognized Brandon University who provides us with space to host our talks without charge.

Outings and nature walks. This past year was a fantastic year of getting outside. Last summer we went to the Lauder Sand Hills where we found a wide range of plants and flowers. We headed to Whitewater Lake for a birding adventure, exploring one of the best wetlands areas in the region. In the Fall we participated in the Hawk watch near Virden. Over the winter, Ken and Rae led us on a snowshoe trek in Riding Mountain National Park. We had a herbarium tour at Brandon University with Dr. McGonigle where participants got to explore a diverse collection of willow specimens. We also explored the landscape of Western Manitoba, through the Arrow Hills Esker and Spruce Woods. Alex thanked all the outing volunteers for sharing their time and expertise.

Citizen science and community events. The WN volunteers led the planning and implementation of the Brandon and Rivers Christmas bird counts. WN participated in the City Nature Challenge, the Great Backyard bird count, and partnered with The Manitoba Important Birding areas (IBA) for red-headed woodpecker counts. We also made time to celebrate our incorporation, have a new membership drive last May, and a member photo-sharing night in December.

Goals and upcoming initiatives. Looking ahead, the WN goals include delivering high-quality outings and presentations, continuing to grow our membership, and fundraising. Our table-top calendars have been a success and there are still some available to purchase. As the WN are officially incorporated we can apply for small grants. For example, this could mean creating plant identification materials for our outings or bringing in experts for a talk or to lead outings. It gives us more flexibility to make the organization even better.

5. Committee reports

Talks/presentations. Alex explained that monthly talks are being held every second Thursday at BU at 7:00 PM from September to May. They are free to everyone, either in person, or online as a hybrid event. The next WN talk is “Signs of Spring: Early Season Plant Identification” scheduled for Thursday, May 14th at 7:00 PM at BU.

Outings. Carson Kearns, is Committee chair, with Gillian Richards, Duane Diehl, and Sandy Hominick. This group meets several times a year to map out each season’s outings. The group confirms leaders for the outings, including subject experts from time to time, locations in south Westman, and other information about the outing such as driving and walking distances, possible hazards and potential sightings. Outing information is distributed via the WN newsletter to all those

on the mailing list and on WN social media outlets. The next evening nature walk will be held May 6th in the Willowdale area.

Communications. Carson is Committee chair, along with Steffi LaZerte and Gillian Richards. The WN has its own website, a monthly to bi-monthly newsletter, and several social media outlets, such as Facebook. The committee's goal is to provide information to all those involved as a member or interested people as quickly and smoothly as possible. Events, resources, articles, ways to help along with WN guidelines and waiver are all made accessible through the website at <https://westmannaturalists.ca>

Organization and planning. Jen Wasko introduced committee members, Kathryn Hyndman, Gillian Richards, and Sandy Hominick. This committee's goal is to help set up processes and structures for the efficient and smooth running of the organization. For example, we have set up bylaws and become incorporated as a Manitoba non-profit organization. These protocols help everyone to know their roles and expected activities. We have just completed two guidelines "Westman Naturalists Inc. Guidelines for Field Trip Participants" and "Westman Naturalists Inc. Guidelines for Field Trip Leaders and Co-Leaders". The guidelines' intent is to ensure a respectful and comfortable environment for all, to promote high-quality enjoyable and safe outings, and to have fun exploring nature together. They are available on the WN website, under Resources.

Treasurer's report. Sandy Hominick, as WN Treasurer presented the 2025 WN financial statement, including revenue and expenses. In 2025 most revenue came from a one-time financial donation from the former Brandon Birders group when we became incorporated, from memberships, and from calendar sales. One of the larger expenses this year is related to the fees for incorporation that totalled \$180.00. The 2025 year-end balance was \$1327.89. The full report is appended at the end of the minutes. Sandy extended a thank you to all current members and to those who purchased the table-top calendars.

Motion: To accept the Treasurer's report as presented.

Mover: D. Ford

Second: K. Chachula

Carried: All in favour

Projected 2026 budget. Gillian Richards presented the WN 2026 budget projections and reviewed each line of revenue and expense estimates. A unique WN logo design is being planned for 2026 and this will be one of the larger WN expenses. The WN project a loss of \$388.75 which will leave \$934.14 in our account. Our goal is to maintain about \$1,000.00 in our account. The 2026 budget projections are included at the end of the minutes.

6. Other business

President Alex asked for questions or if there were other items for discussion. There were none and the meeting moved on to election of Members at large.

7. Election of directors

Members at large. As President, Alex explained the role of WN Members at large and called for nominations.

Motion: That Duane Diehl be nominated for Member at large.

Mover: K. Hyndman

Second: K. Myers

Motion: That Roger Glufka be nominated for Member at large.

Mover: H. Stewart

Second: S. Fry

Motion: That Adrielle Parlee be nominated as Member at large.

Mover: G. Richards

Second: S. Hominick

President Alex indicated he had received written acceptance from D. Diehl that he would accept the nomination. R. Glufka and A. Parlee verbally stated acceptance of their respective nomination. There were no other nominations from the floor. Alex declared nominations were closed. No objections were raised for any of those nominated. Since there were only three nominations for four possible Members at large, Alex declared those nominated to be acclaimed as new WN Members at large. All those who volunteered were thanked.

8. Adjournment

Motion: That the AGM be adjourned at 1347.

Mover: D. Ford

Second: M. Derrer

Carried: All in favour

9. Nature walk

Following refreshments an optional nature walk was held at the Riverbank Discovery Centre, led by Carson Kearns, Kathryn Hyndman and Alex Koiter.

Members present (n=29):

Alex Koiter	Kristopher Myers
Carson Kearns	Colleen Barclay
Gillian Richards	Ken Barclay
Sandy Hominick	Renee Cromley
Jen Wasko	Alison Dawson
Kathryn Hyndman	Lynn Whidden
David Ford	Markus G. Derrer
Adrielle Parlee	Henry Hildebrand
Roger Glufka	Nicola White
Heather Stewart	Phillip LaNeal
Colette Pierce	Leah Lees
Buzz Crowston	Sean Fry
Denice Geverink	Thomas Schude
Kathryn Chachula	Gwyn Richards
Matthew Bollman	

Westman Naturalists Inc. Budget 2025 and 2026				
prepared by WN Organizational Committee & Board			05-Jan-26	
2025				
	Amount	#	Total	TOTAL
Revenue to Dec 31, 2025				
Misc	\$ 15.00	1	\$ 15.00	
Honararium - talk @ Rivers School	\$ 150.00	1	\$ 150.00	
Memberships 2025	\$ 10.00	38	\$ 380.00	
Received from Brandon Naturalists Account	\$ 760.80	1	\$ 760.80	
Donations	\$ 95.00	1	\$ 95.00	
Collection from 2024 Xmas Bird Count	\$ 140.00	1	\$ 140.00	
Senior Event @ Riverbank	\$ 100.00	1	\$ 100.00	
Memberships 2026	\$ 10.00	16	\$ 160.00	
Calendars	\$ 10.00	14	\$ 140.00	
Fund Raiser @ Christmas Potluck 2025	\$ 180.04	1	\$ 180.04	
Total Revenue to Dec 31, 2025			\$ 2,120.84	\$ 2,120.84
Expenses to Dec 31 2025				
Business Cards	\$ 32.50	1	\$ 32.50	
Chq order (never rec'd)	\$ 40.26	1	\$ 40.26	
Transferred to member shares	\$ 5.00	1	\$ 5.00	
Name Registration for Incorporation	\$ 60.00	1	\$ 60.00	
Chq order	\$ 37.90	1	\$ 37.90	
Incorporation Fee	\$ 120.00	1	\$ 120.00	
Seedy Sunday	\$ 20.00	1	\$ 20.00	
Donation for room Xmas Count 2024	\$ 140.00	1	\$ 140.00	
Gifts for Speakers -1 gas card & 3 mugs	\$ 64.01	1	\$ 64.01	
Calendars - 50	\$ 273.28	1	\$ 273.28	
Total Expenses to Dec 31, 2025			\$ 792.95	\$ 792.95
Balance as of Dec 31, 2025				\$ 1,327.89
2026 PROJECTIONS				
Carry forward from 2025				\$ 1,327.89
	Amount	#	Total	TOTAL
Projected Revenue 2026				
Memberships 2026	\$ 10.00	30	\$ 300.00	
Donations	\$ 30.00	1	\$ 30.00	
Sale of Calendars (20 as volunteer gifts)	\$ 10.00	16	\$ 160.00	
Silent Auction from 2026 Xmas Potluck	\$ 150.00	1	\$ 150.00	
Total Revenue 2026			\$ 640.00	\$ 640.00
Projected Expenses 2026				
Annual Incorporation Fee	\$ 45.00	1	\$ 45.00	
Domain cost (5 years) plus addon (\$150+tax)	\$ 152.25	1	\$ 152.25	
Yearly email cost - 2026	\$ 15.75	1	\$ 15.75	
Materials Costs for Thank-you Cards	\$ -	1	\$ -	
Printing Trip Materials	\$ 50.00	1	\$ 50.00	
Printing AGM Materials	\$ 50.00	1	\$ 50.00	
Printing Business Cards	\$ 20.00	1	\$ 20.00	
Logo Design	\$ 300.00	1	\$ 300.00	
Gas for out of town External Speakers	\$ 25.00	2	\$ 50.00	
Costs for 50 Calendars - 2027	\$ 6.00	50	\$ 300.00	
Mailing costs for calendars	\$ 6.00	5	\$ 30.00	
Yearly email cost - 2027	\$ 15.75	1	\$ 15.75	
Gifts for External Outing Leaders & Speakers	\$ -	0	\$ -	
Room Cost for AGM 2026	\$ -	0	\$ -	
Room Cost for Xmas Bird Count 2026	\$ -	0	\$ -	
Total Projected Expenses 2026			\$ 1,028.75	\$ 1,028.75
Net Projected Annual Profit (Loss) as of Dec 31 2026				-\$ 388.75
Projected Balance as of Dec 31 2026				\$ 939.14